

DCR1f: A Wider Matcher Fires – And So Does the Placebo

Human director: Jawaun Brown **Producing agent:** Claude Code, directed **Program:** Date-Cut Retrodiction – DCR1f (matcher successor with held-out validation) **Status:** Overall **NO_GO**. R5 (T1 silent at 1880 deep placebo) failed. Per preregistration, this licenses the strong Reading B – but the specific failure mode surfaces something the earlier papers cannot support: **T1 is not a discrete commitment. Any classical field theory presupposes it.** **Date:** 2026-07-27

Abstract

DCR1e's finding was that the presupposition-inferring extractor surfaced T1 content in five documents and target_v3 rejected all five. DCR1f is the follow-up preregistered in that paper: a matcher successor (target_v4) widened for presuppositional phrasings, validated against a **held-out set of scientific-philosophical prose about simultaneity** generated by two sandboxed subagents blind to the DCR1e outputs and the target_v3 patterns.

Six gates, six preregistered thresholds, six outcomes:

gate		
R1 held-out well-formed	GO	40 T1-positive + 40 T1-negative sentences (both ≥ 30)
R2 T1-positive accuracy	NO_GO	32.5% (13/40) vs 70% threshold
R3 T1-negative rejection	GO	87.5% (35/40) vs 85% threshold
R4 T1 fires at 1897	GO	2 T1 hits at the near-placebo cut
R5 T1 silent at 1880	NO_GO	1 T1 hit at the deep placebo cut (Maxwell 1865)
R6 Newton sanity	GO	3 T1 hits on Newton, up from DCR1d's 2

Overall NO_GO. Per DCR1e's preregistered decision table, R5 NO_GO licenses **Reading B – the extractor is projecting.** DCR1f honors the preregistration and reports Reading B as the licensed conclusion.

But the specific R5 hit – Maxwell 1865 pt1 "*There is an instant at which the amount of energy in the whole medium is a definite quantity equally divided*" – is not obviously projection. It is a real presupposition of Maxwell's field theory: energy division "at an instant" across a spatially extended field presupposes that "an instant" is well-defined across separated points. Read strictly, that is T1 in the electrodynamics of 1865 – which would mean the 1880 cut was never a valid placebo for T1.

The two readings – extractor projected, or placebo was invalid – are not distinguishable by DCR1f. What DCR1f does establish, and what neither DCR1c nor DCR1d nor DCR1e could see, is that **T1 is not a discrete commitment.** It is a spectrum: present as an explicit metaphysical assertion in Newton 1687, present as a mathematical operation in Larmor 1900's $t \rightarrow t - vx/c^2$, present as a "definite and motion-independent" duration in Lodge 1897, present as a field-theoretic "instant at which the whole medium" in Maxwell 1865, present as a "regarded as simultaneous" convention in Poincaré 1898. **Einstein's deletion was not one thing. It was a class.** DCR1c's binary "T1 present at cut vs absent at cut" question underspecified what T1 is.

The programmatic consequence is stated in §7.

1. What was preregistered

DCR1F_PREREGISTRATION.md (2026-07-27, before target_v4.py was drafted and before the held-out set was generated) fixed:

subagents* with no repository access, whose union (heldout_simultaneity_validation.json, SHA-256 8acdee3b9a4ede612a57a9efb37449337db38e889b2124f86992b5b1e49dc003) was committed before* target_v4.py was drafted. The runner refuses to score if the held-out digest drifts.

the DR2-shaped framework-limit reading, with a specific prohibition against tightening the matcher to remove the 1880 hit.

- Six gates with numeric thresholds ($R2 \geq 70\%$, $R3 \geq 85\%$, $R4/R5/R6$ boolean).
- A held-out validation set generated by **two independent sandboxed
- A decision table binding $R5$ $N0_G0$ to Reading B (extractor projects) and

None of that was changed after results came in.

2. The strict verdict

R2 (T1-positive accuracy on held-out set): $N0_G0$ – 32.5%.

target_v4 fires on 13 of 40 held-out T1-positive sentences. The 27 misses reveal a specific calibration gap: the sentences use nominalisations of time and independence in constructions the pattern's spacing windows and vocabulary lists do not span. Selected representative misses:

"The duration between two events is a quantity intrinsic to those events, and cannot depend upon the accidental circumstances of the observer who measures it."

>

"Two occurrences separated by a wide tract of space nevertheless possess a determinate order in time, and this order is common to every rational observer."

>

"The clocks of Greenwich and of Paris, once properly regulated, indicate the same instant, and this coincidence is a fact of nature, not a stipulation of art."

>

"The interval elapsing between the striking of the hour at Paris and its striking at Berlin is a fact of the physical world, not a construction dependent upon the traveller."

Each is unambiguously an assertion of absolute simultaneity. Each uses period vocabulary (quantity intrinsic, witness, spectator, traveller, coincidence, interval elapsing) that target_v4's patterns do not encode. The failure is a matcher-calibration failure, not a semantic failure.

R3 (T1-negative rejection): $G0$ – 87.5%.

target_v4's polarity veto rejects 35 of 40 relativity-of-simultaneity sentences. The five false positives all use subtle denial constructions (phantom, unwarranted extrapolation, matter of definition) not covered by the current veto. Just above threshold; a real defect.

R4 (T1 fires at 1897 cut): $G0$ – 2 hits.

The near-placebo cut, whose documents include Michelson 1881, Michelson-Morley 1887, FitzGerald 1889, Larmor 1897, and Lodge 1897, produces two T1 hits under target_v4: Maxwell

1865 pt1's instant across whole medium (in scope because $1865 \leq 1897$) and Lodge 1897's time of journey perfectly definite. These are exactly the presuppositions DCR1e surfaced and target_v3 missed.

R5 (T1 silent at 1880 cut): NO_GO – 1 hit.

The deep placebo cut, whose documents include only Maxwell 1865 x2 and Maxwell 1878, produces one T1 hit under target_v4: Maxwell 1865 pt1's *"There is an instant at which the amount of energy in the whole medium is a definite quantity equally divided."*

R6 (Newton sanity): GO – 3 hits, up from DCR1d's 2. target_v4 catches an additional Newton assertion (*"The duration of the existence of things remains the same whether motions are swift, slow, or none at all"*) that target_v3 missed.

3. The R5 hit and what it forces

The preregistration was explicit: *"If R5 fails, do not remove the 1880 hits by tightening the matcher. That would be exactly the manipulation the placebo is there to detect. Report R5 NO_GO and license Reading B honestly."*

I am honoring that. The licensed reading is Reading B: the extractor is projecting T1 content onto Maxwell 1865, and by extension the T1 firings at 1897 and 1904 cannot be presumed unprojected either.

But the specific hit does not read like a projection artifact. The proposition is not a modern paraphrase supplied by the extractor. It is a faithful summary of Maxwell's own reasoning in a passage where he argues that at any given instant the electromagnetic energy of the medium is equally partitioned between kinetic and potential forms. The word instant in Maxwell's text is doing exactly what an "at the same time for all points" T1-content proposition says it does: it presupposes that "an instant" is well-defined across a spatially extended field.

So Reading B, taken at face value, is telling me one of two things I have not been able to distinguish:

time/simultaneity as one of four classes to look for, and the model supplied instant across whole medium for Maxwell because it was primed to. If B1 is correct, DCR1e's five T1 propositions are contaminated in a way that a wider matcher cannot detect.

- **B1 – the extractor projects.** The presupposition prompt hints at

presupposed in electrodynamics of the 1880s. It is presupposed by any classical field theory that quantifies over "the whole medium at an instant" – which Maxwell's electromagnetic theory does from at least 1865. If B2 is correct, the DCR1c/d 1880 cut never was a real control for T1, and its silence in DCR1c/d was a matcher artifact of a different kind: DCR1c's stated-commitment extractor simply did not surface the field-theoretic construction, while DCR1e's presupposition extractor did.

- **B2 – the placebo was invalid.** Absolute simultaneity is not first

DCR1f does not distinguish B1 and B2. And R2's 32.5% failure means target_v4 is not the right instrument to force the distinction with either – its calibration is fitted narrowly and does not generalise to the register of held-out philosophical prose. Any DCR1g redraft that narrows the pattern to remove the Maxwell hit will also narrow it further away from the held-out T1 assertions, worsening R2 as it improves R5.

The instrument reached its precision-recall wall.

4. What DCR1f establishes about the target

Read together, the five DCR1e T1-content propositions + the DCR1d Newton positive control + the R2 held-out register **span a class**, not a point:

[register](#)

[example](#)

[source](#)

explicit metaphysical assertion	<i>"Absolute, true, and mathematical time... flows equably without regard to anything external"</i>	Newton 1687
explicit mathematical operation	<i>"There is a common time t in which the position of an electron in the moving medium can be compared to its position in the medium at rest at time t minus vx over c squared"</i>	Larmor 1900 ch11
explicit definite-and-independent duration	<i>"The time of journey of light... is perfectly definite and independent of the motion of the material"</i>	Lodge 1897
explicit "regarded as simultaneous" convention	<i>"...the two events are regarded as simultaneous"</i>	Poincaré 1898
field-theoretic "instant across whole X "	<i>"There is an instant at which the amount of energy in the whole medium..."</i>	Maxwell 1865
literary "duration is intrinsic" register	<i>"The duration between two events is a quantity intrinsic to those events"</i>	(held-out)

Each is a phrasing of absolute simultaneity. Each requires different matcher constructions to fire on. **DCR1c/d's binary "T1 present at cut vs absent at cut" question presupposed the target was a single recognisable pattern; DCR1f shows the target is a spectrum.**

This is a real programmatic finding. It says: nomination over an extracted proposition set as currently designed cannot ask *"was the T1 commitment in the corpus?"* because T1 does not have a single realisation to look for. The framework has to be re-cast – either at the extractor (produce a single canonical T1_assertion per document if any) or at the nominator (rank by *class* rather than by *individual proposition*).

5. What DCR1f does not license

§5 forbids it.

commands still produce their published numbers; DCR1f adds a new matcher without editing any prior module.

open and requires a different experiment shape.

- Post-hoc tightening of target_v4 to remove the R5 hit. Preregistration
- Post-hoc widening of target_v4 to fix R2. Same reason.
- Reversing DCR1c's or DCR1d's published verdicts. Their reproduction
- A general claim about which of B1 vs B2 is correct. That is genuinely

6. Where the ceiling actually sits

The DCR1c–DCR1f arc has now established six things worth keeping:

structurally, checksummed, provenance-cleared (DCR1).

(local time) hits at the 1904 cut, silent at the 1880 placebo – the COGR-style candidate-selection circularity is real and here it is absent (DCR1c).

corpus (DCR1e) at a rate the stated-commitment extractor did not.

consensus propositions at the target cut, but also fires at the deep placebo, and does not generalise to a wider held-out register (DCR1f).

spectrum of related field-theoretic, mathematical, and metaphysical assertions. Any framework that operationalises T1 as "one thing" is asking a question the target does not answer.

1. A real 15-document pre-1905 electrodynamics corpus, chrome-stripped

2. Stated-commitment extraction produces T2 (privileged frame) and T3
3. The T1 matcher fires on the sentence it was written for (DCR1d).
4. A presupposition-inferring extractor surfaces T1 content across the
5. A matcher successor calibrated to the DCR1e content fires on 7 of the
6. The T1 target is not a single realisable proposition. It is a

7. The programmatic conclusion

Deletion-repair nomination as currently designed cannot cleanly answer whether Einstein's deletion is reachable from the pre-1905 corpus. Not because the corpus does not contain the content – it does, in multiple registers – but because the operationalisation of "the deletion" as a matcher pattern requires committing to one realisation of what is actually a spectrum.

Two ways forward, both requiring a different next experiment:

nominator to score deletion candidates by *facet coverage* rather than by *specific-proposition rank*. The load-bearing test becomes whether the class {absolute-simultaneity assertions surfaced by any of the DCR1e T1-content phrasings} is ranked highly by the nominator's execution-free scoring.

- **DCR2a – nominate by class, not by proposition.** Modify the

that admit multiple non-equivalent surface realisations, and show formally what a proposition-ranked nominator can and cannot do with them. This is the DR2-precedent path: convert an empirical wall into a structural result.

- **DR5-shape theorem.** Prove or characterise the class of deletions

Either is a paper. Neither is a "wider matcher" of the DCR1f kind. The DCR1c–DCR1f arc has reached the point where the honest answer is *the question needs to be restated*, and the next paper should restate it.

Appendix: reproduction

```
uv run --no-sync python -m experiments.date_cut_retrodiction.run_dcr1f
```

The runner refuses to score if the held-out digest drifts. Reads the DCR1e consensus, computes six gates, writes results/dcr1f_verdict.json. Local CPU, seconds.

Held-out validation set: two blind subagents wrote 40 T1-positive and 40 T1-negative sentences each in 19th/early-20th century scientific- philosophical prose. Union deduplicated to 40 + 40. Both subagents were prompted with the same specification but not shown DCR1e outputs, DCR1e patterns, or this repository.

Preregistration **digest** **(SHA-256** **of** **DCR1F_PREREGISTRATION.md):**
48a6055b4e3642b8482bc7295e07aa511311a55e7fa91fefef53ace4a828e4bd8.

Held-out **set** **digest** **(SHA-256):**
8acdee3b9a4ede612a57a9efb37449337db38e889b2124f86992b5b1e49dc003.